

RP06

Divisional and District Administration; Board of Revenue

Rajasthan Polity and Administration now runs at 11-14 questions a paper, ahead of Indian Polity. This chapter reliably supplies 2-3 of them. The certain ones are the Board of Revenue at Ajmer (asked 2018), the District Planning Committee (asked 2016 and 2024), the 1962-1987 story of the Divisional Commissioner, and the revenue hierarchy in order. The district and division count is now a standing current-affairs question as well.

This chapter is about who actually runs a district in Rajasthan - the Collector in the middle, the Divisional Commissioner above him, and the long revenue line below him that ends at the Patwari in the village. RPSC loves it because every fact here is a clean one-liner: a seat, a year, a rung in a hierarchy, a chairperson.

District & Divisional Administration

7 divisions, 41 districts

- Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Bikaner, Kota - 1949
- Ajmer - 1987 (sixth)
- Bharatpur - 2005 (seventh)
- Banswara, Pali, Sikar - created 2023, abolished Dec 2024
- Count as of January 2025

Divisional Commissioner

- Abolished 1962 - CM Mohan Lal Sukhadia
- Restored 26 January 1987 - CM Haridev Joshi
- Senior IAS officer
- Revenue appellate authority above the Collector

The Collector's hats

- Collector - revenue
- District Magistrate - law and order
- District Election Officer
- Chairman, District Disaster Management Authority
- District Registrar of births and deaths

Revenue line downward

- SDO / Assistant Collector - sub-division
- Tehsildar - tehsil
- Naib Tehsildar - sub-tehsil
- Girdawar (Kanungo) - group of patwar circles
- Patwari - patwar circle

Board of Revenue

- Ajmer, 1949, Ordinance No. 22
- Chairman + not more than 20 members
- Highest revenue court of the state
- Rajasthan Land Revenue Act 1956, Tenancy Act 1955

Planning & development

- District Planning Committee - Article 243D
- Chaired by the Zila Pramukh
- Four-fifths members elected
- Section 121, Rajasthan Panchayati Raj Act 1994
- Zila Parishad CEO = executive head

The map first - seven divisions, forty-one districts

Sambhag means division. It is a supervisory tier sitting between the state government and the district. It has no legislature and no elected body of its own - it is purely an administrative umbrella over a group of districts. Rajasthan was not born with seven of them. It started with five in 1949, added Ajmer in 1987, added Bharatpur in 2005, briefly went up to ten in 2023, and came back down to seven at the end of 2024. Learn the count with a date attached to it, because this number has moved twice in three years.

- As of January 2025 Rajasthan has 7 divisions and 41 districts.

- Every division is named after its headquarters town - there is no division whose name differs from its HQ.
- The five original divisions of 1949: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Bikaner, Kota.
- Ajmer became the sixth division in 1987 - the same year the Divisional Commissioner's post came back.
- Bharatpur became the seventh division in 2005 - the newest division that still exists.
- Banswara, Pali and Sikar divisions were created in 2023 and abolished in December 2024.

The seven divisions of Rajasthan

Division	Created	Remember it by
Jaipur	1949	One of the original five
Jodhpur	1949	One of the original five
Udaipur	1949	One of the original five
Bikaner	1949	One of the original five
Kota	1949	One of the original five
Ajmer	1987	Sixth - created when the Commissioner's office was restored
Bharatpur	2005	Seventh and newest surviving division

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the map is settled at 41 districts and 7 divisions. The state cabinet decision of 28 December 2024 scrapped 9 of the 17 districts created in 2023 and all 3 of the new divisions. The nine that went: Dudu, Kekri, Shahpura, Neem Ka Thana, Gangapur City, Jaipur Rural, Jodhpur Rural, Anupgarh and Sanchore. The eight that survived: Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Kotputli-Behror, Khairthal-Tijara, Phalodi and Salumbar.

TRAP

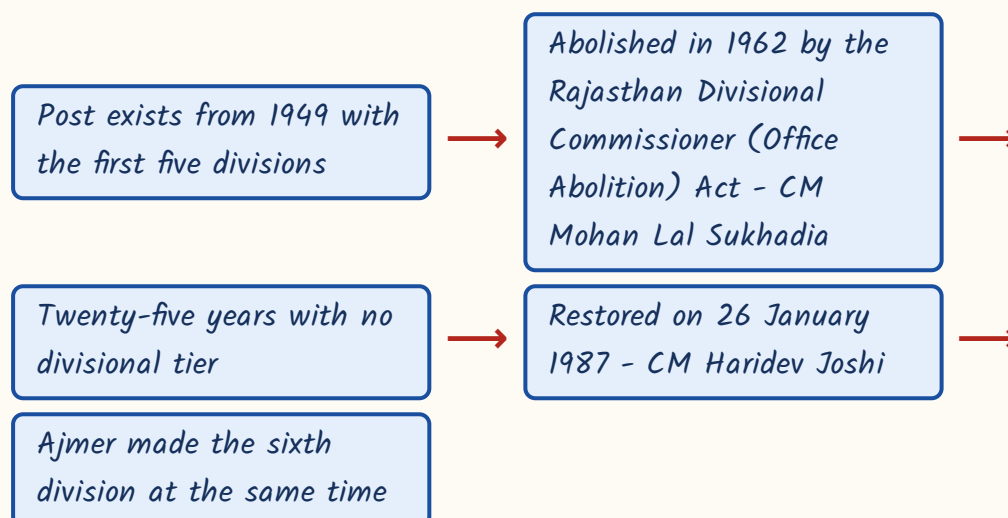
Do not write 50 districts or 10 divisions. That was the 2023 position and it lasted about a year. From January 2025 the answer is 41 and 7. Read the as-on date printed in the question - if RPSC dates the question to 2023 the correct answer changes, and that is exactly the kind of trick the paper likes.

- Jaisalmer is in Jodhpur division.
- Jhalawar is in Kota division.
- Banswara is again a district of Udaipur division.
- Hanumangarh is in Bikaner division.

The Divisional Commissioner - abolished once, brought back once

The Divisional Commissioner sits between the state government and the Collectors of his division. He is a senior IAS officer. He runs no department of his own; his work is supervision, coordination and appeal. The examinable part is not what he does day to day - it is the odd history of the post, which was killed and then revived twenty-five years later.

The story of the Divisional Commissioner's office



- He supervises the district administration of every district in his division.
- In revenue matters he is an appellate authority above the Collector.
- He coordinates development work and inspects district offices.
- He is posted by the State Government from the IAS - he is not elected by the Zila Parishads or by anybody else.
- Two names to fix: Sukhadia abolished the post, Haridev Joshi restored it.

The District Collector - one officer, many hats

In the district the same IAS officer wears four or five hats at once. He is Collector for land revenue, District Magistrate for law and order, District Election Officer when elections come, and chairman of the District Disaster Management Authority when a disaster comes. RPSC's favourite format here is the negative one - which of the following is NOT a function of the Collector. The answer is almost always something elected, because the Collector holds no elected office.

The Collector's hats

Capacity	What he does under it	Where the role comes from
Collector	Assessment and collection of land revenue; custodian of government land	Rajasthan Land Revenue Act, 1956
District Magistrate	Law and order; prohibitory orders; arms and explosives licensing	Section 163 of the BNSS, which replaced Section 144 CrPC
District Election Officer	Electoral rolls and conduct of elections in the district	Election law, under the Election Commission
Chairman, DDMA	District disaster preparedness and response	Disaster Management Act, 2005
District Registrar	Registration of births and deaths in the district	Births and deaths registration law

- He is appointed by the State Government from the IAS cadre.

- The Superintendent of Police works under his general direction - but the Collector is not the SP's appointing authority.
- The District Rural Development Agency (DRDA) is the district agency for centrally sponsored rural development schemes.
- As District Magistrate he is the head of the criminal-executive machinery, not of the criminal courts.

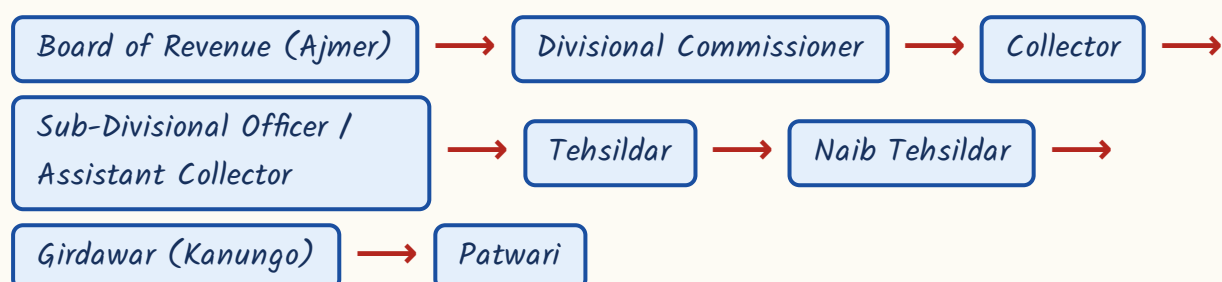
TRAP

The Collector does NOT head the Zila Parishad. The Zila Parishad's elected head is the Zila Pramukh; its executive head and ex-officio secretary is the Chief Executive Officer. Any option that makes the Collector president of the Zila Parishad is the planted wrong answer.

Below the Collector - the revenue ladder down to the Patwari

Below the Collector the land revenue machinery runs in a straight line down to the village. Learn it as a ladder, top to bottom, because the ordering question is the standard format in this chapter. Each rung also has its own territory, and the territory is the second half of the matching question RPSC builds from it.

Land revenue hierarchy, top to bottom



Who sits on which territory

Functionary to territory

Functionary	Territory	Core job
Divisional Commissioner	Division (sambhag)	Supervision and revenue appeals above the Collector
Collector	District	Revenue head of the district and District Magistrate
Sub-Divisional Officer	Sub-division	Link between district and tehsil; also Sub-Divisional Magistrate
Tehsildar	Tehsil	Revenue head of the tehsil; exercises the powers of an Assistant Collector
Naib Tehsildar	Sub-tehsil	Heads a sub-tehsil
Girdawar (Kanungo)	A group of patwar circles	Directly supervises the Patwaris
Patwari	Patwar circle	Maintains the khasra; carries out girdawari

- The Revenue Appellate Authority is a separate appellate rung interposed between the Collector and the Board of Revenue.
- The Patwari is the lowest revenue functionary; the patwar circle is the smallest unit of revenue administration.
- The Sub-Divisional Officer is the officer who links the district to the tehsil - that exact wording gets used in the question.
- The Vikas Adhikari (Block Development Officer) is NOT part of the revenue line - he belongs to the panchayat samiti, the development line.

YAAD RAKHO

Ladder mnemonic, read upwards from the village: Patwari - Girdawar - Naib - Tehsildar - SDO. P-G-N-T-S. Say it upwards once and any ordering question in this chapter becomes free marks.

The vocabulary of land records

Four or five Rajasthani revenue words come back again and again, usually as a matching set or as a not-correctly-matched question. They are not difficult. They only have to be kept clearly apart from one another.

Revenue vocabulary you must be able to match

Term	What it means
Jamabandi	The record of rights of a village
Khasra	The field-wise register of plots
Girdawari	Periodical crop inspection carried out by the Patwari
Bandobast	Settlement operations - the assessment of land revenue
Patta	The document of title or allotment held by a landholder

TRAP

Patta is not settlement. Settlement is bandobast. The wrong pair RPSC plants is 'Patta - periodic settlement of land revenue'. Patta is a title document; bandobast is the operation.

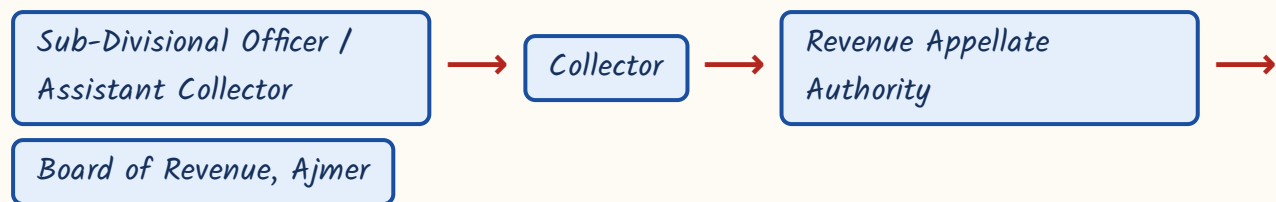
The Board of Revenue at Ajmer - the top of the revenue judiciary

The Board of Revenue for Rajasthan is a court, not a department. Appeals, revisions and references in land revenue and tenancy matters end here - it is the highest revenue court of the state. Its seat at Ajmer is the single most asked fact of this whole chapter, so fix that first and the rest is detail.

- Created by Ordinance No. 22 of 1949 on 7 April 1949; enforced from 1 November 1949.
- Seat: Ajmer.
- Composition under the Rajasthan Land Revenue Act, 1956 - a Chairman and not more than 20 members.

- Its members are appointed by the State Government.
- It exercises superintendence over all subordinate revenue courts in the state.
- The two parent statutes: Rajasthan Land Revenue Act, 1956 and Rajasthan Tenancy Act, 1955 (in force 15 October 1955).
- Do not mix it up with the Rajasthan Civil Services Appellate Tribunal at Jaipur, which hears service appeals of state employees.

The route a revenue appeal travels



Board of Revenue vs Rajasthan Tax Board – both sit at Ajmer

Board of Revenue	Rajasthan Tax Board
The state's highest revenue court	The state's appellate body in commercial tax matters
Created by Ordinance No. 22 of 1949	Also seated at Ajmer – that shared address is the trap
Chairman plus not more than 20 members	A separate hierarchy – no appeal lies from the Board of Revenue to it
Parent law: Rajasthan Land Revenue Act, 1956	Deals with tax, not with land

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 – where is the Board of Revenue for Rajasthan located? Answer: Ajmer. Remember that Ajmer also holds the RPSC and the Rajasthan Tax Board, so 'Ajmer' is the safe answer whenever a Rajasthan body is not in Jaipur.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2018 also ran the same body in statement format - seat at Ajmer, constituted in 1949, highest court of appeal in revenue matters. All three statements are correct. When RPSC returns to a body it usually returns in the statement format, so learn three facts about each body, not one.

The District Planning Committee - this chapter's repeat cluster

District planning is a constitutional requirement, not a state courtesy. Article 243ZD, inserted by the 74th Amendment, requires every state to constitute a District Planning Committee in each district to consolidate the plans prepared by the panchayats and the municipalities into a draft development plan for the district as a whole. In Rajasthan the enabling provision is Section 121 of the Rajasthan Panchayati Raj Act, 1994, and the chair goes to the Zila Pramukh - not to the Collector.

- Constitutional basis: Article 243ZD.
- State provision: Section 121 of the Rajasthan Panchayati Raj Act, 1994.
- Chairperson in Rajasthan: the Zila Pramukh, the elected head of the Zila Parishad.
- Not less than four-fifths of the members must be elected from among the elected members of the panchayats and municipalities of the district.
- The remaining one-fifth may be nominated - so 'all members are nominated' is always a wrong statement.
- The committee forwards the draft district development plan to the State Government.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - District Planning Committees are provided for under which Article of the Constitution? Answer: Article 243ZD. Do not confuse it with Article 243ZA, which is about elections to municipalities.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and asked again in RAS Pre 2024 - who chairs the District Planning Committee in Rajasthan? Answer: the Zila Pramukh. Two papers, the same answer. This is the highest-probability single fact in the chapter.

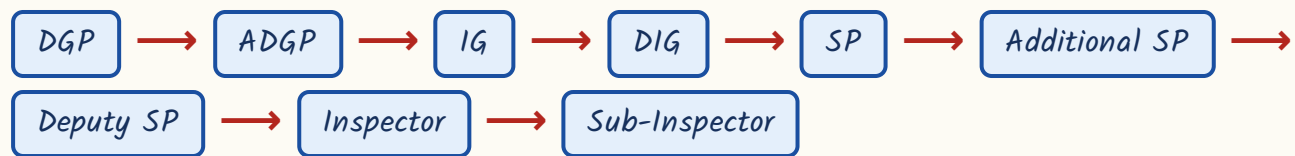
YAAD RAKHO

Fix the fraction as four-fifths - not two-thirds, not three-fourths. Tie it to the Article: 243ZD, where ZD stands in your head for Zila Development, and the elected share is four out of five.

- Zila Pramukh = the elected political head of the Zila Parishad.
- Chief Executive Officer (an IAS or RAS officer) = the executive head and ex-officio secretary of the Zila Parishad.
- So in the district the same body has one elected head and one official head - keep the two roles apart.

Police, disaster and the other district bodies

The district is not only revenue. Two other lines run beside it - the police under the Superintendent of Police, and disaster management under the Collector. Both give short, clean one-liners in the paper, so they are worth ten minutes.

State police hierarchy, top to bottom

- The SP is an IPS officer and heads the district police outside commissionerate areas.
- He functions under the general direction of the District Magistrate.
- Rajasthan runs the police commissionerate system in two cities only: Jaipur and Jodhpur.
- Under the Disaster Management Act, 2005 the District Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the District Collector.
- At the state level the Rajasthan State Disaster Management Authority is chaired by the Chief Minister.

Who heads what at the district level

Body	Headed by
District administration	District Collector
District police, outside commissionerates	Superintendent of Police
District Disaster Management Authority	District Collector
Zila Parishad	Zila Pramukh, elected; the CEO is the executive head
District Planning Committee	Zila Pramukh
District Legal Services Authority	District Judge

REVISION RECAP

1. 7 divisions and 41 districts as of January 2025 - always answer with the date attached.
2. Original five divisions of 1949: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Bikaner, Kota. Ajmer 1987, Bharatpur 2005.

3. Banswara, Pali and Sikar divisions lived only from 2023 to December 2024.
4. Divisional Commissioner: abolished 1962 by Sukhadia, restored 26 January 1987 by Haridev Joshi.
5. The Divisional Commissioner is the revenue appellate authority immediately above the Collector.
6. The Collector is Collector, District Magistrate, District Election Officer, DDMA chairman and District Registrar - all at once.
7. Prohibitory orders now come from Section 163 of the BNSS, the successor to Section 144 CrPC.
8. Revenue ladder upwards: Patwari - Girdawar - Naib Tehsildar - Tehsildar - SDO - Collector - Divisional Commissioner - Board of Revenue.
9. Patwar circle is the smallest revenue unit; the Girdawar supervises Patwaris; the Vikas Adhikari is outside this line.
10. Jamabandi = record of rights; khasra = field register; girdawari = crop inspection; bandobast = settlement; patta = title document.
11. Board of Revenue: Ordinance No. 22 of 1949, seat Ajmer, Chairman plus a maximum of 20 members.
12. Rajasthan Land Revenue Act 1956 and Rajasthan Tenancy Act 1955 are the two parent revenue statutes.
13. Revenue Appellate Authority sits between the Collector and the Board of Revenue.
14. Rajasthan Tax Board is also at Ajmer but is a separate commercial-tax hierarchy.
15. District Planning Committee: Article 243ZD, Section 121 of the Rajasthan Panchayati Raj Act 1994, chaired by the Zila Pramukh.
16. Four-fifths of the DPC must be elected from panchayat and municipal members.
17. Zila Parishad: Zila Pramukh is the elected head, the CEO is the executive head and ex-officio secretary.
18. Police commissionerates operate only in Jaipur and Jodhpur; elsewhere the SP heads the district police.
19. DDMA is chaired by the Collector, RSDMA by the Chief Minister, DLSA by the District Judge.